

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Accomplishing by Means of Limitless Doors'

Ārya-Anantamukhāsādhaka-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 525 · Derge Kangyur

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The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Accomplishing by Means of Limitless Doors," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Anantamukhāsādhaka-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phags pa sgo mtha' yas pa sgrub pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī sūtra set against the poignant backdrop of the Buddha's final months before his parinirvāṇa. The text opens with the Blessed One dwelling in Vaiśālī, where he announces to the assembled monks and bodhisattvas that he will pass into nirvāṇa after three months, providing the dramatic occasion for the teaching and transmission of this dhāraṇī. As a dhāraṇī text, it belongs to a class of scripture concerned with the preservation and empowerment conveyed through sacred formulas, here framed within a narrative of the Buddha's imminent passing. It is catalogued as Toh 525 in the Kangyur, situated among the dhāraṇī collections of that canon.

Rejoicing in the Blessed One's words, they bowed their heads at his feet in homage and then vanished from that very place. This completes the text.

In the language of India: Ārya-Anantamukhāsādhaka-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Accomplishing by Means of Limitless Doors."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Vaiśālī, in the magnificent multi-storied hall of the great grove, together with a great Saṅgha of eight thousand monks and a great many bodhisattvas, great beings. At that time the Blessed One, remaining fully mindful and fully knowing, let go of the life-formations, saying: "When these three months have passed, the Tathāgata will pass completely into nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, go and gather here, to this magnificent multi-storied hall of the great grove, all the monks dwelling throughout a thousand world-systems." The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana replied, "As you say, Blessed One," and, heeding the Blessed One's command, in that very instant, by the power of his own miraculous ability, he stood upon the summit of Mount Meru and made his voice heard throughout a thousand world-systems,

proclaiming in verse:

All you beings who are disciples of the Sugata,
all who dwell within these world-systems, hearken!
Today the Teacher rains down a shower of Dharma here —
let all who wish to hear it come to this place!

At that time, forty thousand monks gathered in the magnificent multi-storied hall of the great grove. Having arrived and seen the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated him three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, by the power of the Buddha, thought to himself in that very instant: "By whatsoever miraculous power I might display, whether it be for those of the śrāvaka vehicle, those of the pratyekabuddha vehicle, or those of the Great Vehicle — could I, by such a display of miraculous power, gather here to this magnificent multi-storied hall of the great grove all the monks, however many there are, dwelling throughout the great trichiliocosm? Would such a display of miraculous power suffice?" Then the venerable Śāriputra displayed just such a miraculous power. By means of that display, all the monks throughout the great trichiliocosm, whether of the śrāvaka vehicle, the pratyekabuddha vehicle, or the Great Vehicle, gathered together in the magnificent multi-storied hall of the great grove. Having arrived and seen the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated him three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then, in that very instant, the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattvas, great beings, as follows. He spoke to the bodhisattva great being named Amoghadarśin, and to youthful Mañjuśrī, and to the bodhisattva great being who abandons all lower rebirths, and to the bodhisattva great being who definitively destroys the darkness of all sorrow, and to the bodhisattva great being who completely dispels all obscurations, and to

the bodhisattva great being Netted Light, and to the bodhisattva great being whose intelligence definitively destroys the darkness of all realms, and to the bodhisattva great being Avalokiteśvara, and to the bodhisattva great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta, and to the bodhisattva great being whose mind is never wearied, and to the bodhisattva great being Gandhahastin, and to the bodhisattva great being Vīra, and to the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha, and to the bodhisattva great being Amitābha, and to the bodhisattva great being Matī, and to the bodhisattva great being Jñānaketu, and to the

bodhisattva great being Bhadrapāla, and to the bodhisattva great being Ocean of Intelligence, and to the bodhisattva great being Inexhaustible Intelligence, and to the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, and to the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha, and to the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi, and to the bodhisattva great being Samantabhadra, and to the bodhisattva great being Accumulated Eloquence, and to the bodhisattva great being Maitreya, he declared:

"Sons of good family, you are this very day to gather into this fine storied hall of the great grove all the bodhisattvas dwelling throughout the buddha-fields of all ten directions, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā — whether they are bodhisattvas in their final existence, or bodhisattvas bound by a single birth, or irreversible bodhisattvas, or bodhisattvas who have attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena, or bodhisattvas who are devoted through faith."

Then those bodhisattva great beings, having hearkened to the Blessed One, replied to him, "Excellent! Excellent, Blessed One!" and in that very instant performed such a miraculous act. Through the performance of that miracle, there arrived in the fine storied hall of the great grove bodhisattvas in their final existence — innumerable hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of billions; bodhisattvas bound by a single birth — ninety times a hundred thousand tens of millions of billions; irreversible bodhisattvas — eighty times a hundred thousand tens of millions of billions; bodhisattva great beings who had attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena — thirty times a hundred thousand tens of millions of billions; and bodhisattva great beings devoted through faith — eight times a hundred thousand tens of millions of billions.

All of these arrived, and upon seeing the Blessed One they bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, upon seeing that great assembly of bodhisattvas, thought to himself in that very instant: "Through what manner of teaching and prophesy will these bodhisattva great beings come to abandon all doubts, to swiftly attain unobstructed wisdom and eloquence, to hear the Dharma taught by all the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly complete buddhas in buddha-fields as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, and having heard it, to retain it, never to forget it until they fully and perfectly

awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening? And what are the four aspects of the completely pure conduct of bodhisattva great beings that they will come to attain? What are these four? They are: the complete purification of sentient beings,

the complete purification of Dharma, the complete purification of aspiration, and the complete purification of buddha-fields — these they will come to attain. And what are the four aspects they will come to attain that bring forth the delightful and the pleasing? They are these four: a pleasing body, pleasing speech, a pleasing mind, and a pleasing rebirth — these they will come to attain. And what are the four gateways of entry into dhāraṇī that they will come to attain? They are these four: the gateway of entry into dhāraṇī accomplished through the inexhaustible gate; the gateway of entry into dhāraṇī through mastery of the faculties of sentient beings; the gateway of entry into dhāraṇī that is unconditioned, through mastery of karma and its ripening; and the gateway of entry into dhāraṇī through patient acceptance of the profound Dharma — these they will come to attain. Such are the questions that I have not yet been able to put to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, having recalled those questions he had spoken, having kept them in mind, having thoroughly gathered them together, presented them at length to the Blessed One. He also said this: "May the Blessed One please explain how, by virtue of those questions as they were spoken and kept in mind and thoroughly gathered together, the conduct of these bodhisattva great beings may be completely purified."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Śāriputra with these words: "Excellent, excellent, Śāriputra! It is excellent that you have the thought to put this matter to the Tathāgata. Therefore, Śāriputra, listen well and hold it in mind — I shall explain it to you."

The venerable Śāriputra replied to the Blessed One, "So be it," and listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then spoke to him as follows:

"Śāriputra, in this regard, the bodhisattva great being who does not grasp at or take up any phenomenon whatsoever — such a one should hold to these dhāraṇī mantra words:

tadyathā: oṃ aṇe mahāraṇe akhe mukhe mukhe samantamukhe saume sau sauryarame gautiyugame nirugati prabhehile hile kalampe kelapa sisale saravati hile hile hile hile hili hili li mahāhilele caṇḍe capane caracaraṇi acale

macāle anante anantamukhe anantagate araṇe nirmalade niravalaṇe
nirvadhanate dharmadhardhare nirharegimilī śrīmavīśodhani prakṛtidhīpane
bhavabhe bhavanane asaṃge asaṃge vihare dame same pīmale
vimalaprabhe saṃkaraśaṇi dhire dhidhirila hādhidhire yeṣe yaśobhati cale
acale macale samacale ṭadhiṭudha sandhiṣṭhira asaṃge asaṃge vihare
asaṃganirahare nirahara vimale nirahara ṭaśotani ṭadhisodhe sṭhire sṭhime
sṭhamabhavati mahāprabhe samantaprabhe vipulaprabhe
vipularaśmisambhave samantamukhe sarvatrayabhugate chedyayanata
chedyapratibhane dharaṇi ṇiṭane dharmanidhanagothra samantabhadra
sarvatathāgatahṛdaya adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

"Śāriputra, the bodhisattva great being who holds these dhāraṇīs does not form any proud or conceited attitude toward conditioned and unconditioned phenomena, does not apprehend them as objects, does not wish for them, does not remain indifferent to them, does not take them up, and does not strive after them.

He does not act in order to attain them, abandon them, cultivate them, or cause them to increase. He does not alter them, does not accumulate them, does not perceive phenomena that are associated with them, and does not perceive phenomena that are unassociated with them. He does not perceive the arising of phenomena, nor does he perceive their cessation. He does not perceive past phenomena, nor future phenomena, nor phenomena of the present. He does not perceive the increase or decrease of phenomena. He does not accumulate any phenomenon whatsoever, does not diminish it, does not impute it, and does not cognize it distinctly. He simply meditates on the recollection of the buddhas alone. And in that meditation, it is not form, nor is it formless; not a major mark, nor is it without major marks; not a minor excellent feature, nor is it without minor excellent features; not consciousness, nor is it without consciousness; not affliction, nor is it without affliction; not moral discipline, nor is it without moral discipline; not meditative absorption, nor is it without meditative absorption; not wisdom, nor is it without wisdom; not liberation, nor is it without liberation; not the gnosis of liberation-vision, nor is it without the gnosis of liberation-vision; not birth, nor is it birthless; not of a family lineage, nor is it without family lineage; not of a clan, nor is it without a clan; not a retinue, nor is it without a retinue; not abiding, nor is it without abiding; not attainment, nor is it without attainment; not direct realization, nor is it without direct realization; not the exhaustion of afflictions, nor is it the non-exhaustion of afflictions; not the aggregates, elements, and

sense bases, nor is it without aggregates, elements, and sense bases; not knowing, nor is it without knowing; not teaching the Dharma, nor is it not teaching the Dharma; not the purification of oneself, nor the purification of another; not the purification of sentient beings, nor the purification of what is without sentient beings; not for one's own benefit, nor for the benefit of others; not Dharma, nor discipline; not the purification of body, not the purification of speech, not the purification of mind, not the purification of conduct; not the purification of conduct at the beginning, not the purification of conduct at the end, not the purification of conduct in the present; not one's own purification, and not another's purification.

This, Śāriputra, is called the recollection of the buddhas that is the entry into the non-grasping of all phenomena by a bodhisattva, a great being. It is the dhāraṇī called "attaining fearlessness in the perfect gathering of all phenomena for the accomplishment of the ultimate." It is the meditative absorption called "through attaining singular certainty, bringing all intentions to complete fulfillment." By accomplishing the gnosis that is entirely independent of others regarding all roots of virtue, it is the dhāraṇī called "abiding without being overwhelmed by the family of excellent features and marks that are the treasury of the Dharma." By being skilled in perfectly seeking the supreme, it is the dhāraṇī called "perfectly transcending all the works of Māra."

Śāriputra, those bodhisattvas who attain the meaning of this dhāraṇī accomplished through boundless gateways shall be irreversible and shall swiftly awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. Why is that? Because, Śāriputra, all buddhas in this regard are definite treasuries of qualities and Dharma.

It is because from this very dhāraṇī of conduct free from object-reference, all the conduct of bodhisattvas shall be perfectly distinguished.

Then at that time the Blessed One declared these verses:

Having no fear that phenomena are empty,
and not elaborating for the sake of awakening,
not disturbing the dharmadhātu —
for that reason one shall attain this dhāraṇī.

One should listen to this sūtra;
within it the dhāraṇī is inexhaustible.
This wealth of wisdom is found right here,

and from here one shall attain awakening.

The fearless bodhisattva
who firmly takes hold of this dhāraṇī
shall hear the Dharma taught
by the buddhas of all ten directions.

The supreme Dharma of every
meaning, syllable, and movement —
as many as the rays of the sun —
that many teachings shall one come to know.

Those who become supreme in the Dharma,
the gateways of the great-wave dhāraṇī —
to whoever holds this sūtra,
all of these shall forever become manifest.

Even if all sentient beings
were to question that one for an aeon,
and every last doubt were cut away,
still that one's wisdom would be inexhaustible.

Whoever delights in this sūtra
is a child of the Dharma-king,
close to the supreme awakening,
trustworthy and a holder of the Dharma.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī —
all sentient beings shall rejoice in that one,
the buddhas too shall be pleased with that one,
and renown shall arise throughout the world.

Whoever holds this sūtra —
when the time of death arrives,
that one shall see eight hundred million buddhas
who shall draw near and extend their hands.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī —
whatever misdeeds were done before
throughout ten billion aeons —
in a single month those shall be purified.

All the merit a bodhisattva
has accumulated over ten billion aeons —
whoever holds this dhāraṇī
shall surpass it in a single month.

Even if all sentient beings of the three realms
were to become māras,
they could not create obstacles
for whoever holds this sūtra.

Until awakening is fully attained,
that one shall be endowed with mindfulness, intelligence, and realization.
Whatever is the supreme of dhāraṇīs
shall abide on the tip of that one's tongue.

Just as the holder of this sūtra
individually ascertains this dhāraṇī,
from this omniscience is taught,
from this awakening shall be attained.

The very moment this dhāraṇī was proclaimed,
Dīpamkara gave me a prophecy.
In that very instant, buddhas
as many as the sands of the Gaṅgā were seen.

Whoever, wishing to realize
what all buddhas have taught here,
relies upon this sūtra —
shall swiftly attain it all.

Pure buddha-fields,
and excellence among hearers,
purity of light and marks as well —
all this shall be accomplished by this sūtra.

Therefore, if one is diligent,
and contemplates this for seven days,
eighty hundred million buddhas
shall bestow the dhāraṇī upon that one from beneath.

Do not think about what is to be thought about,
and do not think about what is not to be thought about.
Settle your mind; do not think of contradictions —

then the dhāraṇī shall be attained.

For example, like a person who has reached the ocean
and has no doubt about the wealth there —
likewise, having attained this dhāraṇī,
one has no doubt about bliss.

Perfect awakening is close through this;
therefore apply yourself to this.
Having attained the abode of peace,
one shall attain perfect awakening.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with four qualities shall attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: not having excessive attachment to desired objects; having no envy toward any sentient being; giving away all one's possessions and practicing generosity without regret; and delighting in the Dharma day and night and longing for the Dharma. Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with these four qualities shall attain this dhāraṇī.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Those who are wicked and who dwell in the domain of māra —
abandon desires, for they are foul.
These are conditions for the hells of sentient beings
and are also the causes of the lower destinies.

Do not be envious toward others
for the sake of knowledge, gain, and fame.
If one looks upon sentient beings with joyful eyes,
one will become powerful and beautiful in form as well.

The very ground that certain sentient beings
hold on to leads them into conflict.
Therefore abandon whatever you become attached to.
If craving is abandoned, the dhāraṇī will be attained.

If you desire awakening, think not of others.
Day and night, seek the Dharma.
If one relies on teachings of this very kind,
the dhāraṇī will become fully manifest.

Śāriputra, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with four qualities shall attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: dwelling in forest solitude and seclusion; generating the power of patience with respect to the profound Dharma; having no excessive attachment to gain, honor, and verses; and not regarding any pleasant thing with desire, giving up even body and life. Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with these four qualities shall attain this dhāraṇī.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Dwell in the solitude praised by the Victors.

One who dwells there holds no contempt for others.

Having aroused the aspiration for patience with the profound,
dwell with vigilance, as if your head were ablaze.

Thus as the foundation for hypocritical conduct,
do not abide in knowledge, gain, and possessions.
Being content with plain robes, like a bird,
ensure that the fruit of being truly human is obtained.

Alas — the teaching of the buddhas is well found!
Abandon the household too, the root of many sufferings.
By fully purifying body, speech, and mind,
show reverence to the buddhas and the Dharma.

Longing for gain is not mindfulness, not wisdom,
not faith, not moral discipline, not the mind of Dharma.
That is far from awakening — as far as heaven from earth.
Therefore, utterly abandon gain.

Śāriputra, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with four qualities shall attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: one should penetrate the meaning of eight syllables. What are those eight? They are as follows. The syllable PA: penetrating the understanding that, at the ultimate level, all phenomena are without self. The syllable LA: penetrating the understanding of the Tathāgata's dharmakāya with and without the major and minor marks of excellence. The syllable BA: penetrating the understanding that is non-dual with respect to the phenomena of the childish and the phenomena of the wise, just as they are. The syllable DZA: penetrating the understanding of the non-arising and non-ceasing of beings who have and who have not birth, aging, and death — without arising or ceasing. The syllable KA:

penetrating the understanding of the karmic maturation of actions and of the absence of karmic maturation. The syllable DHA: penetrating the understanding, through the Dharma-categories of the dhāraṇī, of emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness, and the dharmadhātu. The syllable ŚA: penetrating the understanding of the suchness of all phenomena with and without calm abiding and insight. The syllable KṢA: all phenomena are momentary —

— being primordially at peace, they are without exhaustion, without fear, without motion; and they penetrate the understanding that all phenomena enter into nirvāṇa. This, then, is the penetrating understanding of the meaning of those eight syllables — and that is the first penetrating understanding.

The second penetrating understanding is this: to write out well and then hold this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī.

The third penetrating understanding is this: to apply oneself with diligence to reading this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī aloud each fortnight and to keeping it constantly in mind.

The fourth penetrating understanding is this: the great bodhisattva who ardently practices this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī should apply themselves with diligence in order to bring all sentient beings to genuine joy, to lead them to hold it rightly, and to encourage them in it with true praise.

Śāriputra, if a great bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, they will attain this dhāraṇī.

Thereupon the Blessed One then spoke these verses:

Contemplate these eight syllables.

Write out this sūtra and preserve it.

Each fortnight read it aloud without cease.

And lead sentient beings to hold it as well.

Great wisdom and awakening draw near thereby.

In all ten directions, whatever buddhas there are

Who remain — one sees them all face to face.

Therefore arouse aspiration and train in this.

Śāriputra, these four are the benefits for the great bodhisattva who ardently practices this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: all the buddhas and Blessed Ones of the ten directions hold that person in their thoughts; māra finds no opportunity against them; their karmic obscurations are swiftly purified; and they swiftly attain an eloquence that flows without interruption.

Śāriputra, these four are indeed the benefits for the great bodhisattva who ardently practices this dhāraṇī.

The Blessed One then spoke these verses:

All buddhas hold that person in their minds.

Māra will find no opening against them.

Their karmic obscurations will be swiftly purified.

And they will attain boundless eloquence.

Śāriputra, in the past, in a time long gone, during innumerable — and even far more than innumerable — vast, immeasurable, and incalculable aeons, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Glorious King Resembling the Splendor of a Precious Jewel, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, guide of persons to be tamed, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a Blessed Buddha.

Śāriputra, when that Blessed One — that Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Glorious King Resembling the Splendor of a Precious Jewel — was on the verge of passing into complete nirvāṇa, there arose a wheel-turning king named Holder of Light, a human lord possessed of the seven precious royal treasures. He had a son named Inconceivable Splendor of Precious Qualities. When that son had reached the age of sixteen, he heard this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī accomplished through limitless gateways from the Blessed One, that Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Glorious King Resembling the Splendor of a Precious Jewel. The very moment he heard this dhāraṇī, he resolved to apply himself with diligence in order to attain it.

For seventy thousand years he was not overcome by dullness, nor oppressed by sleep. Not once in all that time did he take delight in sovereignty, in wealth, or in his own self. For those seventy thousand years he never once yawned broadly, but remained constantly settled in perfect inner stillness. He heard the Dharma taught by ninety billion buddhas, and having heard it, retained it all. Having retained it, he then went forth into renunciation under that very Blessed One, that Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha, Glorious King Resembling the Splendor of a Precious Jewel. After going forth, when ninety thousand years had passed, he accomplished this dhāraṇī accomplished through limitless gateways, and having accomplished it, he explained it widely and correctly to sentient beings. In that one lifetime alone

he led eight hundred trillion sentient beings to grasp unsurpassable, fully and perfectly complete awakening, and established them on the ground of non-regression.

Śāriputra, in that assembly there was a merchant's son named Crest of the Moon. He heard this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī accomplished through limitless gateways from that Dharma-teaching monk. Having heard it, he rejoiced with sympathetic joy, and by the root of virtue born from that moment of sympathetic joy, he heard the Dharma taught by ninety billion buddhas, and retained it all. In every respect he became supreme among those who had attained dhāraṇī, supreme among those of noble speech, and supreme among the great bodhisattvas whose eloquence flows without interruption. For three aeons he gave pleasure to those Tathāgatas, those arhats, those fully and perfectly awakened buddhas. Having given them pleasure, when those three aeons had passed, he manifestly and fully awakened to unsurpassable, fully and perfectly complete awakening.

Śāriputra, if you should feel uncertainty, doubt, or hesitation about whether the one who at that time and in that life was called the merchant's son Crest of the Moon was someone other than yourself — Śāriputra, you should not think of it that way. Why is that? Because the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Dīpaṃkara — at that time and in that life he was the one known as the merchant's son Crest of the Moon.

Śāriputra, if you should feel uncertainty, doubt, or hesitation about whether the one who at that time and in that life was the Dharma-teaching monk known as Inconceivable Splendor of Precious Qualities was someone other than yourself — Śāriputra, you should not think of it that way. Why is that? Because the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Amitāyus — at that time and in that life he was the Dharma-teaching monk known as Inconceivable Splendor of Precious Qualities.

Śāriputra, as for myself and the great bodhisattvas of this Fortunate Aeon — at that time we too heard this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī, and having heard it, we rejoiced with sympathetic joy. By the root of virtue born from that moment of sympathetic joy, I wandered in saṃsāra for four hundred trillion aeons. I also heard the Dharma taught by ninety-nine billion buddhas, and in every respect became supreme among those who had attained dhāraṇī, supreme among those of noble speech, and supreme among the great bodhisattvas whose eloquence flows without interruption.

Śāriputra, this being so, any great bodhisattva who wishes to quickly and manifestly awaken to unsurpassable, fully and perfectly complete awakening should make effort to engage in sympathetic joy toward even just this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī. Why is that?

That itself becomes the cause for that great bodhisattva to attain the irreversible ground on the way to unsurpassable, fully and perfectly complete awakening, and to gladden those who teach the Dharma. What need is there to speak, then, of one who copies it in writing, recites it aloud, retains it, reads it, fully masters it, takes it to heart with proper attention, and extensively and correctly teaches it to others? The measure of that accumulation of merit is something that no sentient being other than a Tathāgata is able to know or conceive.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Upon hearing this sūtra and rejoicing in it in turn,
writing it down, retaining it, and reading it —
the river of merit thereby generated
cannot be known by any sentient being.

One who does so will see the Victors in every lifetime,
and from them will obtain inconceivable faith.

One will come to understand the nature of the profound sūtras,
and will swiftly and manifestly awaken to awakening.

Even until unsurpassable awakening is reached,
one will not decline in meditative absorption, clairvoyance,
dhāraṇīs, physical form, wealth and enjoyments,
or the vision of the buddhas.

Recollecting through memory the lives of former times,
when the merchant's son obtained this dhāraṇī,
he beheld buddhas as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges,
and through that he awakened to awakening just as he had wished.

At that time the merchant's son was Dīpaṃkara.

In those former lifetimes he was called Limitless Rays of Light.

At that time the Dharma-teaching buddha was Amitāyus,
and I rejoiced together with the fortunate aeon.

Whoever wishes to quickly touch awakening,
whoever wishes to swiftly overcome the māras,

whoever wishes for the auspicious marks adorned with a hundredfold merit — if one strives in this, it will not be difficult to find.

Even if one were to fill world-realms as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges with precious things and give them away as gifts, that merit would not even serve as a comparison to the merit of writing and retaining this.

Therefore, upon hearing it, with one-pointed attentiveness, let the wise bodhisattva retain this, and those who write out this dhāraṇī and reflect upon it are said to find awakening without difficulty.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, the eight yakṣas of powerful radiance who dwell on the ground will come to guard, protect, and shelter, day and night, the body of any great bodhisattva who strives with ardor in this dhāraṇī accomplished through limitless gateways. Who are these eight? They are these: the yakṣa called Heroic, Steadfast, Sovereign, Power of the Son of Indra, Intellect of Conduct, Hard to Endure, Fearsome, and the yakṣa called Fine-Handed — these eight yakṣa kings. In order to bring those yakṣa kings to appear, one should bathe very thoroughly, put on very clean clothing, go to an open walking place, and cultivate a mind free of hostility toward all sentient beings. One should also take this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī to heart, and having taken it to heart in that way, those eight yakṣas will quickly appear before one.

The following eight reborn among the gods of the desire realm will also turn their minds toward that great bodhisattva. Who are these eight? They are these: the great bodhisattva called Illuminator, Maker of Light, Radiance of Wisdom, Sunlight, Truly Inspiring, Fulfiller of All Intentions,

King of Stars, and the great bodhisattva called Intelligent Conduct. Those eight great bodhisattvas will exert themselves in order that the one who practices this dhāraṇī may attain it. The great bodhisattva who strives in this dhāraṇī should likewise make a truthful vow. One should strive earnestly in gratitude for what has been done, in the sense of experiencing what has been done, in desiring the Dharma, in delighting in the Dharma, and in patient acceptance of the profound Dharma. The great bodhisattva who strives in the dhāraṇī should adopt the conduct of one who gives generously. In that regard, if one should give as a gift even what is meager and small, there is no need to speak of

giving what is more abundant.

When the Blessed One taught this Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī, as many as thirty times ten trillion bodhisattvas equal in number to the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā attained this dhāraṇī accomplished through limitless approaches, and became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. As for gods, humans, and asuras who had previously not yet aroused the mind of awakening, sixty times ten trillion attained irreversibility, and awakened the mind directed toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma-category? How shall I hold it in mind?" The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, Śāriputra, hold this Dharma-category in mind under the name 'The Dhāraṇī Accomplished through Limitless Approaches.' Hold it also under the name 'That Which Causes a Bodhisattva to Distinctly Transcend Singleness of Certainty.' Hold it also under the name 'That Which Utterly Destroys All Māras.' And hold it also under the name 'That Which Causes One to Attain Supremely the State of Omniscience in All Aspects with Singleness of Certainty.'"

Having declared this, the Blessed One's words were received with joy by the venerable Śāriputra, by those monks, by those bodhisattvas, and by

Translator's Notes

- The passage begins with what appears to be a colophon or closing formula from one text, immediately followed by the opening of a new dhāraṇī text, the Ārya-Anantamukhāsādhaka-dhāraṇī. The transition is abrupt in the source and has been rendered faithfully.

The bodhisattva name "Amoghadarśin" renders the Tibetan "mthong ba don yod," meaning "one whose seeing is fruitful or not in vain," which corresponds to the Sanskrit Amoghadarśin. The passage ends mid-sentence in the list of bodhisattvas, reflecting where the provided source text breaks off.

The phrase "let go of the life-formations" renders the deliberate releasing of the will-to-live, a well-attested narrative event at the approach of the Buddha's parinirvāṇa in both Pāli and Sanskrit sources.

- The bodhisattva name རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་ renders literally as "Great Incense Elephant," corresponding to the Sanskrit Gandhahastin; this is a recognized bodhisattva name in such assembly lists. The name རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་ renders as "Guardian of the Good," corresponding to Bhadrāpāla. The passage contains two bodhisattvas both bearing the Tibetan name འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་ (Ākāśagarbha); this appears to reflect either a scribal repetition or a distinct figure with the same name in the source text — the translation renders both occurrences faithfully as given.

- The dhāraṇī passage is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit

syllables. The Tibetan orthography is irregular and reflects a late or corrupt transmission; the transliteration above normalizes lightly for readability in a TTS context but makes no claim to a critical reconstruction of the original Sanskrit. Significant variants almost certainly exist in Sanskrit manuscript traditions.

The phrase rendered "does not form any proud or conceited attitude" translates *rlom sems su mi byed*, literally "does not make it into an object of pride or conceit" — a standard Mahāyāna formulation warning against reifying even the dhāraṇī practice itself.

- The phrase rendered as "the gnosis of liberation-vision" translates a compound referring to the wisdom that sees or cognizes liberation, a standard Abhidharma and Mahāyāna category for the cognition that directly perceives one's own or another's liberation. The list of paired negations throughout is a characteristic apophatic enumeration found in Prajñāpāramitā-style literature, affirming that the meditation on buddha-recollection transcends all conceptual categories without falling into either extreme of affirmation or negation.
- The verse "The very moment this dhāraṇī was proclaimed, Dīpaṃkara gave me a prophecy" refers to Śākyamuni's past-life prophecy from the buddha Dīpaṃkara (Dīpaṃkara, "Lamp-bearer"), a foundational biographical episode in Buddhist tradition. The Tibetan "འཇིགས་མེད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་རྒྱུ་ལྟར་འཇིགས་མེད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་རྒྱུ་ལྟར་" is the Blessed One speaking in the first person, confirming this as a retrospective autobiographical verse by Śākyamuni.
- The passage contains a dhāraṇī syllable-exegesis section in which eight Sanskrit syllables (PA, LA, BA, DZA, KA, DHA, ŚA, KṢA) are each glossed with a doctrinal meaning. These are real Sanskrit syllable-letters being interpreted through a bīja-like or arapacana-style hermeneutic; they are rendered here as capitalized syllables in plain Latin letters, which is appropriate for TTS narration and consistent with how such syllabary-exegesis texts function.

The verse line rendered "do not abide in knowledge, gain, and possessions" translates a line warning against resting in the basis of hypocritical or pretense-driven conduct (假名三寶), specifically the triad of fame-knowledge, gain, and verse-recitation used to impress others; the reading is consistent with the preceding prose's warning against attachment to gain, honor, and verses.

- The epithet sequence for the buddha — Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha — renders the standard Tibetan trikāya-style honorific chain, here expanded to the full ten epithets on first full occurrence. I have rendered the abbreviated repetitions faithfully. The name Glorious King Resembling the Splendor of a Precious Jewel is a fairly literal rendering of Rin chen dpal gyi gzi brjid rgyal po lta bu; the simile particle lta bu ("resembling" or "like unto") is part of the buddha's name itself, not a comparison, and is retained accordingly.
- The phrase rendered "ninety billion" translates bye ba phrag dgu bcu, literally "nine times ten ten-millions," which equals nine hundred million. The same figure also appears as bye ba phrag dgu bcu rtsa dgu near the end, meaning "ninety-nine times ten ten-millions" or 9.9 billion; both are rendered accordingly. These astronomical figures are conventional hyperbolic enumerations in this sūtra-style literature and do not require doctrinal comment.

The identification of the merchant's son Crest of the Moon with Dīpaṃkara, and of the Dharma-teaching monk Inconceivable Splendor of Precious Qualities with Amitāyus, are theologically significant revelations of past-life identity and should be noted as the structural climax of this narrative section.

- The passage's reference to Dīpaṃkara as a past identity of the speaker — alongside Amitāyus as the teaching buddha of that era — is a noteworthy doctrinal claim about the Blessed One's past lives. The verse "I rejoiced together with the fortunate aeon" (bskal pa bzang dang bcas yi rang) frames the Śākyamuni Buddha as having practiced sympathetic joy alongside the current Fortunate Aeon, which is a distinctive narrative element worth registering

for the listener's orientation.

The list of eight yakṣa kings ends mid-enumeration in the source text (with "Fine-Handed"), and the list of eight bodhisattvas among the desire-realm gods is likewise cut off at the end of the supplied passage. The translation faithfully renders what is present without inventing completions.

- The phrase "○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○ ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○" is somewhat compressed. Literally it suggests "one who preserves what has been done" and "one who feels / experiences what has been done," pointing to a quality of gratitude and karmic sensitivity. The rendering here follows the most natural doctrinal reading but the exact connotation may belong to a specific list whose commentary would clarify further.

The titles given for the dhāraṇī render the Tibetan quite literally;

"सिद्धं तत्तुल्यं चैव नित्यं सार्वभौमिकं
सर्वत्राद्यन्तःस्थानं सर्वज्ञं सर्वशक्तिम्"
could alternatively be rendered "That Which Causes Singular, Definite, Manifest Transcendence," but the reading given above is consistent with the bodhisattva context.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.